ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Side Hustles and Freelancing: Earn Without Damaging Your Degree

Find a skill, price it fairly, and get paid without being scammed

MONEY & CAREER

Money & Career

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Many students want income but start with no skill and no plan. This pack helps you choose a realistic hustle, build one service people actually pay for, price it, find your first five clients and avoid the scams that target young freelancers.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Choose a side hustle that fits your skills, timetable and capital.
- Package one clear service and price it with a simple method.
- Find and convert your first clients without spamming.
- Protect yourself with deposits, written scope and clear delivery terms.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Pick a realistic hustle

Match the hustle to your time, capital and existing skill.

- Service hustles need time and skill, not capital: writing, design, tutoring, virtual assistance, transcription, social media management.
- Product hustles need capital and storage: reselling, food, print and design.
- Skill-based hustles pay more over time because the skill compounds.
- Avoid anything requiring upfront payment to 'unlock' jobs.
- Avoid gambling, betting syndicates and get-rich-quick schemes presented as business.

- Choose one and give it ninety days before judging it.

Package and price

Clients buy outcomes, not effort.

- Describe the service as a deliverable: 'a 1,500-word SEO article with five sources'.
- Set a minimum price rather than charging by hour at the start.
- Calculate your cost of delivery: data, transport, software, time.
- Charge a deposit for custom work, especially with new clients.
- Raise your price when demand exceeds your capacity, not when you feel brave.
- Put scope, revisions and deadline in writing for every job.

> **Cheap clients are expensive**
> A client who argues about a fair price before hiring usually argues about everything after delivery.

Find clients and get paid safely

Your first clients are usually closer than you think.

- Start with people who already know your work: classmates, departments, small businesses nearby.
- Build a simple portfolio of three samples, even if self-initiated.
- Use a clear profile and one platform consistently.
- Send specific messages referencing the client's actual need.
- Receive payment before delivering final files, or split into deposit and balance.
- Keep records of income and be transparent about it.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Name two service hustles with low startup capital.

Answer: Tutoring and freelance writing. Virtual assistance, transcription and social media management are also low-capital.

2. Why is a written scope important?

Answer: It prevents endless revisions and disagreements about what was promised.

3. How should you price your first service?

Answer: Calculate delivery cost, check what comparable services charge, set a minimum acceptable price and avoid underpricing to win work.

4. What is a deposit for?

Answer: It reduces the risk of a client refusing to pay after work has begun and confirms commitment.

5. Why avoid hustles that require paying to get a job?

Answer: Legitimate employers pay workers; upfront fees are a common fraud pattern.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] List three skills you already have.
- [ ] Choose one service and write its deliverable in one sentence.
- [ ] Create three sample works for your portfolio.
- [ ] Write a client message template that is specific, not generic.
- [ ] Set your minimum price and deposit policy.
- [ ] Pitch five potential clients this week.
- [ ] Record every job, payment and client contact.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

> **More from the ZikShare Academic Vault**
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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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